



# HAORAN ZHENG

## AI RESEARCHER

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Chicago, IL, USA

### ABOUT ME

Current Pre-Doctoral Fellow at UChicago Booth in Quantitative Marketing with Professor Andreas Kraft.  
Graduated with M.S. in Data Science from The University of Chicago with a 4.0 GPA. Earned bachelor's degrees in Economics, Finance, and History as a triple major at The Ohio State University.  
Experienced in teaching roles across STEM fields, including Statistics.  
Recipient of the Pace Setters Award.

### PUBLICATIONS

When to Think Fast and Slow? AMOR: Adaptive Entropy Gate for Hybrid Models

Under review · ICLR 2027

Conceptizer: Next-Token Prediction Is Not All You Need

To be submitted · ACL Rolling Review

Does Listing Text Predict Prices in the Age of AI?

Working paper · preprint forthcoming

Do AIs Dream of Electric Butterflies? Benchmarking LLM Consciousness via Theory-Grounded Self-Reports

PsyArXiv preprint · Oct 2025

SCENE: Evaluating Explainable AI Techniques Using Soft Counterfactuals

arXiv preprint · Aug 2024

### LINKS

Personal Website:

[haoranzhengraul.github.io](https://haoranzhengraul.github.io)

LinkedIn Profile:

[linkedin.com/in/haoran-zheng-04a9551ba](https://linkedin.com/in/haoran-zheng-04a9551ba)

### WORK EXPERIENCE

#### Dr. Andreas Kraft

The University of Chicago  
Booth School of Business  
Jun 2025 – Present

#### Dr. Nicholas Epley

The University of Chicago  
Booth School of Business  
Sep 2024 – Jun 2025

#### Mindworks Lab

The University of Chicago  
Booth School of Business  
Apr 2024 – Jun 2025

#### Dr. Christopher Reed

The Ohio State University  
Apr 2024 – May 2025

#### China Automotive Systems

NASDAQ: CAAS  
May 2021 – May 2023

#### The Ohio State University

Feb 2021 – May 2022

#### Research Professional in Quantitative Marketing

- Researching whether listing text predicts prices in the age of AI.

#### Research Assistant in Behavioral Science

- Collaborated closely with Dr. Nicholas Epley and Yale PhD candidate Yin Li on "The Multicultural Study," focusing on cross-cultural perceptions of beliefs and preferences.

#### Research Specialist in Behavioral Science

- Examined frontier behavioral science research on prospect theory and diminishing sensitivity.
- Co-managed studies and collected data for Dr. Alexander Todorov and Dr. Sarah Sebo.

#### Research Assistant in History

- Applied modern NLP techniques and the SCENE method to traditional history research.
- Identified the significance of previously unseen historical documents.

#### Financial Analyst

- Conducted financial analysis and modeling for automotive industry applications.

#### Lead Teaching Assistant for Statistics 2320

- Taught two weekly recitations for 65 students each, focusing on statistical concepts and analytical tools (R).
- Developed customized review notes and visual aids for 900+ enrolled students each semester.

### EDUCATION

#### The University of Chicago

Chicago, IL  
2024

#### The Ohio State University

Columbus, OH  
2022

#### Master of Science in Data Science

- Thesis: "Demystifying the Black Box: Evaluations of Explainable AI Techniques in NLP" (Advisor: Dr. Utku Pamuksuz).

#### Bachelor of Science in Economics

- Triple major in Economics (GPA 3.9/4.0), Finance (GPA 3.8/4.0), and History (GPA 3.8/4.0).

### ACTIVITIES

- Soccer: played for the Columbus Crew (Major League Soccer) reserve team, 2016–17 season.
- E-sports: competed professionally in Pro Evolution Soccer 2017; ranked 45th on the American continental server; semifinalist at the US National Championship; YouTube channel "FlyinGodzilla."
- Muay Thai & kickboxing: sanctioned bouts (1–1 record).
- Photography.